

HA! CD Burner

Impressive!

HA! CD Burner, a CD recording software made in Taiwan, supports CD as well as DVD media. The software has all the necessary elements such as Disc Copier, Raw Copier, Audio Copier, MP3 CD,



HA! CD Burner is the new kid on the write

Video CD, Super VCD, etc. You can also create audio CDs on the fly from MP3 format. Just drag-n-drop MP3 files in the wav copier, and your audio CD is ready.

The manual was outdated—it mentioned only support for CD-R and CD-RW, when in fact, it also supports DVD burn-

ing. The documentation didn't even mention some features related to CD-burning such as Video CD, Super VCD, etc.

Performance-wise, it's similar to other applications such as Nero. It also offers most of the features such as multi-session, drag-n-drop, image creation, etc. A few features such as format CD, over burning, copy protection support are missing.

The interface is simple and won't even scare a novice. At Rs 2,700, it's a good software to buy as it performs well and has the required features.

SPECIFICATIONS

Media supported:CD-R/RW, DVD-RAM, DVD-R/RW, and DVD+RW/+R; supports Windows 98, Me, NT, 2000 and XP

Price: Rs 2,700
Contact: Mediaman Infotech Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-23823100
E-mail: alok@mediamangroup.com
Web site: www.acard.com

HA! CD Burner		A-
Performance	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Features	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Ease of Use	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Value for money	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	

SMC SMC2655W Wi-Fi Access Point

Freedom of movement

The SMC2655W is a tiny device that measures about 117 x 62 x 22 mm, and weighs under 100 gms. It comes with the external dipole antenna, and works on the Direct Sequence Spread Spectrum type radio signal.

The utility bundled with it is easy to use and set up.

It comes with a default IP and DNS that are needed to access it. These can be changed of course. You can also enable MAC-level filtering by creating and adding a MAC address list to it. Thus, only devices that match the MAC address list will be allowed access. This is a must have, especially when the neighbours also have a wireless network.

Though the SMC2655W claims to offer speeds of 11

Mbps at a distance of 128 metres, our tests showed otherwise. It took us 12 minutes and five seconds to transfer a 200 MB single file—a data transfer speed of approximately 2.2 MBps only; and this was at a distance of just 12 metres, with only a single user connected and even the line-of-sight criteria satisfied for best performance. So though it claims to support up to 32 users per device, practically, this doesn't seem feasible.

The access point came bundled with a power adapter,

Price: Rs 8,000
Contact: SMC Networks
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Web site: www.smc-asia.com

the utility software CD and a manual that explains the setup process. We recommend this device for a wireless network wherein most data transfers are just surfing and e-mail access, and that too, for a small group of users.

SPECIFICATIONS

802.11b compliant, 2.4 GHz operating frequency, dipole antenna, 825-feet operating range, supports 64 or 128-bit Wired Equivalent Privacy (WEP) encryption, support for up to 32 users

SMC SMC2655W Wi-Fi Access Point		B
Performance	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Features	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Ease of use	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Value for money	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	

Wacom Graphire 3 G-430 Pen Tablet

The pen is mightier than the mouse

The Wacom Graphire 3 combines the accuracy and ease-of-use of a pencil to draw images, along with the enhanced functionality of the mouse as a pointing device.

The well-designed cordless pen sports an electronic eraser at its end. The re-programmable dual side-switch can be assigned functions such as right-clicks and double-clicks. The tablet's surface has a smaller customisable active area to detect the pen's motion and replicate it correspondingly onto the screen.

We had to manually enable the pen's pressure sensitivity in Photoshop, but otherwise it was quite precise. However, as the pen

activates within 5 mm of the tablet's surface, novices may find it tricky to use.



With a price tag of Rs 5,400, the Graphire 3 is a better buy for design professionals and artists.

SPECIFICATIONS

Tablet size: 8.27 x 8.20 inches, active area size: 3.65x5.02 inches, pen accuracy: ±0.02 inches, bundled software: Painter Classic, PhotoExpress 4 SE, Pen Plus Personal

Price: Rs 5,400
Contact: Trifin Information Technology Ltd
Phone: 011-26236061
Fax: 011- 26436447
ashish@trifintech.com
Web site: www.wacom.com

Wacom Graphire 3 G-430 Pen Tablet		B+
Performance	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Features	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Ergonomics	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	
Value for money	▬ ▬ ▬ ▬ ▬	

